

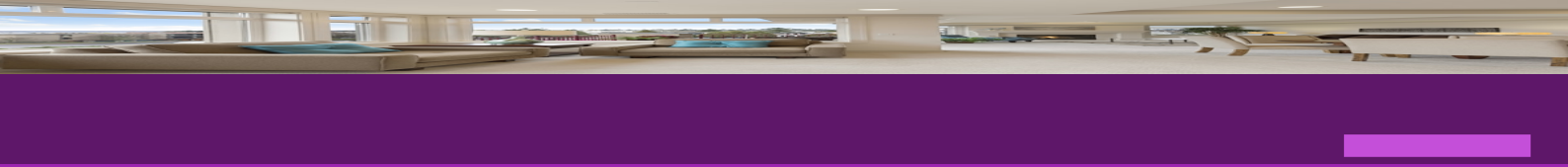
Rent an Apartment

Beijing Neighborhood Guide:

Where Expats Live in 2026

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Beijing Neighborhood Guide: Where Expats Live in 2026

Choosing the right neighborhood in Beijing can make or break your experience as an expat. This guide breaks down the most popular areas where foreigners live, with real rent prices, transport links, and lifestyle tips for each area.

1. Sanlitun (三里屯) -- Chaoyang District

The beating heart of Beijing's expat scene. Sanlitun offers a cosmopolitan lifestyle with international restaurants, bars, shopping malls (Taikoo Li), and the embassy district nearby. Most young professionals and single expats choose this area for its vibrant nightlife and walkability.

* Rent: ¥6,000-12,000/month (1BR apartment)

* Nearest metro: Tuanjieshu (Line 10), Dongsi Shitiao (Line 2)

* Best for: Young professionals, nightlife lovers

* Nearby: Taikoo Li, Nali Patio, The Opposite House, Element Fresh, Great Leap Brewing

2. CBD / Guomao (国贸) -- Chaoyang District

Beijing's Central Business District is where many multinational companies are headquartered. Modern high-rise apartments with stunning city views, premium shopping at China World Mall, and easy access to Line 1 and Line 10. Popular with corporate expats and finance professionals.

* Rent: ¥8,000-20,000/month (1BR luxury apartment)

* Nearest metro: Guomao (Line 1/10), Jintaixizhao (Line 10)

* Best for: Corporate expats, finance professionals

* Nearby: China World Mall, CCTV Headquarters, Kerry Centre

3. Liangmaqiao (亮马桥) -- Chaoyang District

Known as the "embassy area," Liangmaqiao is home to many foreign embassies, international hotels, and upscale restaurants. The area has a more relaxed, residential feel compared to Sanlitun while still being centrally located. Many expat families choose this area for its safety and international community.

* Rent: ¥7,000-15,000/month (1BR apartment)

* Nearest metro: Liangmaqiao (Line 10)

* Best for: Embassy staff, expat families

* Nearby: Lufthansa Center, Kempinski Hotel, Japanese and Korean restaurants

4. Wangjing (望京) -- Chaoyang District

Wangjing has transformed from a quiet residential area into a bustling expat neighborhood, often called Beijing's "Koreatown." It's home to many tech companies



(Alibaba, Meituan offices) and offers excellent Korean and international dining. Modern apartment complexes with good amenities at more affordable prices than central Chaoyang.

* Rent: ¥4,500-9,000/month (1BR apartment)

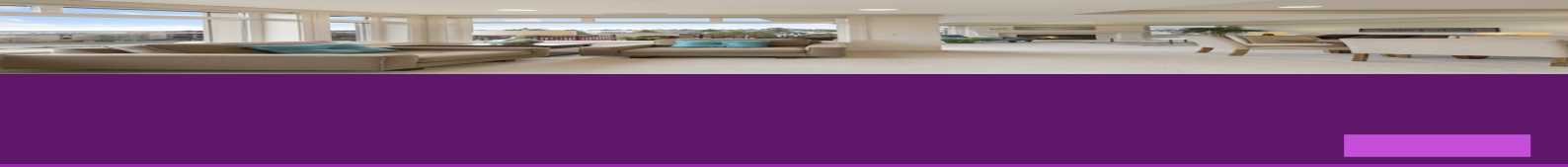
* Nearest metro: Wangjing (Line 14/15), Wangjing South (Line 14)

* Best for: Tech workers, Korean food lovers, budget-conscious expats

* Nearby: Wangjing SOHO, Korean restaurants, Wanda Plaza

5. Wudaokou (五道口) -- Haidian District

Known as "宇宙中心" (Center of the Universe) among Chinese students, Wudaokou is the student hub of Beijing. Surrounded by Peking University, Tsinghua University, and Beijing Language and Culture University, it's the most affordable expat-friendly area. Great for students and young professionals on a budget.



* Rent: ¥3,500-7,000/month (1BR apartment)

* Nearest metro: Wudaokou (Line 13)

* Best for: Students, budget-conscious young professionals

* Nearby: University campuses, Korean and Japanese restaurants, bars, bookstores

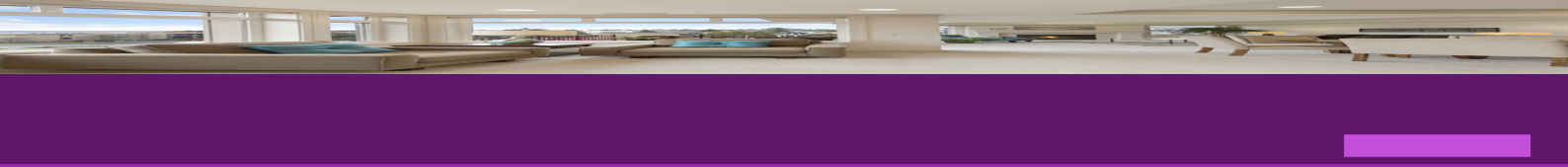
6. Shunyi (顺义) -- International School Belt

Shunyi is where most expat families with school-age children live. Home to major international schools (ISB, WAB, Dulwich), it offers villa communities with gardens, space, and a suburban lifestyle. The trade-off is a longer commute to central Beijing (40-60 minutes).

* Rent: ¥10,000-30,000/month (villa with garden)

* Nearest metro: Shunyi (Line 15), but most residents drive

* Best for: Expat families with children



* Nearby: International schools, Europlaza, Pinnacle Plaza, River Garden

How to Choose Your Neighborhood:

* Budget under ¥5,000/month:

* Wudaokou, Wangjing, or shared apartment in Chaoyang

* Budget ¥5,000-10,000/month:

* Sanlitun, Liangmaqiao, Wangjing (1BR)

* Budget ¥10,000+/month:

* CBD luxury apartments, Shunyi villas

* With kids:

* Shunyi (international schools) or Liangmaqiao (central, safe)

* Near work:

* Use

* Baidu Maps

* to check commute times

Pro Tip:

Before signing a lease, visit the neighborhood at different times -- morning rush hour, evening, and weekend. Check the nearest metro station distance, grocery stores (look for

Womai

or

Hema/盒马

for delivery), and the general vibe. Join the neighborhood's WeChat group to connect with other expats.

Sources: Sources: [Ziroom](https://www.ziroom.com) • [Lianjia](https://www.lianjia.com) • [Beike](https://www.ke.com) • [Beijing Kids](https://www.beijing-kids.com)

The background of the cover is a photograph of a modern, bright interior space, likely a living or dining area, with large windows on the left showing a view of a lake and buildings. The room features light-colored walls, a beige sofa, and a dining table with chairs. Overlaid on this background are several graphic elements: a large purple circle in the center, a smaller dark grey circle in the top left, a purple rectangle in the top right, a purple rectangle in the bottom left, and a dark grey circle in the bottom right.

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